

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | KQL | M365 Defender | Detection Engineering | ISO 27001

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

A Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience securing enterprise networks, cloud environments, and end-user estates within large, complex organisations. Specialist in Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection engineering, Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender (including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI)), and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation. Experienced in collaborating with Managed Security Service Provider (MSSP) Security Operations Centres (SOCs) to maintain and tune detection catalogues, building automated reporting dashboards using Microsoft Sentinel workbooks, and supporting ISO 27001 security activities at enterprise scale. Brings a methodical, architecture-aware approach to incident detection, threat hunting, and security improvement programmes, with proven expertise in analytic techniques for incident detection and the ability to apply secure design principles across enterprise networks, cloud platforms, and end-user environments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL - advanced), detection rule authoring and tuning, Sentinel workbooks and dashboards, threat hunting analytics, detection catalogue management; CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM; Splunk (Search Processing Language (SPL))
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender; CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) - Expert
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps and playbooks, PowerShell scripting, automated alert enrichment, response orchestration, and workflow automation
- **Security Architecture and Design:** Secure architecture across enterprise networks, cloud (Azure), and end-user environments; Zero Trust principles; Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory (Azure AD)) Conditional Access; identity security design
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), Group Policy
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, risk-based remediation prioritisation
- **Endpoint and Device Security:** MDE, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Tanium
- **Frameworks and Compliance:** ISO 27001, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus, NIST 800-61 Incident Response, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Apply analytic techniques for incident detection across enterprise networks, cloud (Azure), and end-user environments, using Microsoft Sentinel and KQL to identify, investigate, and respond to threats across the full estate.
- Author, maintain, and continuously tune a detection catalogue of KQL analytics and hunting queries in Microsoft Sentinel, aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques to ensure high-fidelity alerting and minimal false positive rates.
- Build automated reporting dashboards using Microsoft Sentinel workbooks, providing senior stakeholders and the security leadership team with real-time visibility of the organisation's threat detection metrics, incident volumes, and risk indicators.

- Collaborate with internal and external Security Operations Centre (SOC) partners to maintain and improve the detection catalogue, sharing threat intelligence, reviewing detection coverage gaps, and aligning response playbooks to identified threat scenarios.
- Design and implement SOAR automation playbooks using Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps and PowerShell to orchestrate alert enrichment, Indicator of Compromise (IOC) lookups, automated containment, and ticketing workflows.
- Support ISO 27001 security activities including internal audit preparation, control evidence collection, risk register maintenance, and Statement of Applicability (SoA) reviews across enterprise network, cloud, and end-user security domains.
- Apply secure architecture principles across enterprise network, cloud, and end-user environments, advising on security design decisions for new projects, infrastructure changes, and third-party integrations.
- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), managing detection policies, alert configurations, and integrations with Microsoft Sentinel to ensure comprehensive M365 Defender coverage.
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon EDR (including NG-SIEM, Insight and Discover) as a complementary endpoint detection and response layer, configuring custom detection rules and threat hunting queries.
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) Conditional Access, MFA, and identity security controls, ensuring secure access to cloud and on-premises resources in line with Zero Trust principles.
- Lead vulnerability management using Pentra BAS, Tenable.io, AppCheck and Nessus, coordinating remediation activities across IT and development teams and reporting risk status to senior leadership.
- Manage BeyondTrust PAM, enforcing least-privilege access, auditing privileged sessions, and supporting ISO 27001 access control requirements.

University of the Arts London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Delivered L2/L3 security monitoring, alert triage, and incident investigation using SIEM, EDR, and email security platforms, applying structured analytic techniques to identify genuine threats within high-volume alert environments.
- Played a key role in the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across an 8,000-user estate, configuring onboarding policies, alert rules and integration with Microsoft Sentinel for unified M365 Defender operations.
- Authored and tuned Microsoft Sentinel detection rules and analytics queries, improving the fidelity of the detection catalogue and reducing false positive volumes to maximise analyst efficiency.
- Built and maintained Microsoft Sentinel workbook dashboards to provide operationally relevant reporting on alert trends, incident volumes, and key security metrics for the security leadership team.
- Conducted identity and access management reviews in Azure AD, identifying stale accounts, over-privileged roles and configuration gaps, and coordinating remediation in line with ISO 27001 access control requirements.
- Performed vulnerability scanning using Nessus and AppCheck, producing risk-prioritised remediation reports and tracking closure through to verified resolution.
- Supported ISO 27001 activities including control evidence preparation, internal audit support, and risk register updates across network, endpoint, cloud, and identity security domains.
- Managed Mimecast email security controls and conducted phishing and business email compromise (BEC) investigations, implementing preventive controls to reduce recurrence.
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus certification, producing technical evidence across cloud, endpoint and network security control areas.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Managed IT security and infrastructure for a SaaS and Financial Technology (FinTech) organisation, applying secure design principles across cloud (Azure), network, and end-user environments.
- Supported ISO 27001 gap analysis and remediation activities, documenting security controls and producing evidence for internal and external audit purposes.
- Deployed and maintained endpoint security, firewall, and identity management tooling, including Azure AD configuration and MFA rollout for remote and office-based staff.

- Conducted security risk assessments, identifying weaknesses across cloud-hosted platforms and on-premises systems and producing remediation plans aligned to ISO 27001 Annex A controls.
- Supported security incident identification and triage, applying investigative techniques to identify root cause and prevent recurrence of security events.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed a comprehensive library of MITRE ATT&CK-aligned KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, improving alert fidelity and significantly reducing Mean Time to Detect (MTTD) across enterprise network, cloud, and end-user environments.
- Built a suite of automated Microsoft Sentinel workbook dashboards providing senior leadership with real-time visibility of threat detection metrics, incident trends, and security KPIs, replacing manual reporting processes.
- Led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across an 8,000-user estate, integrating fully with Microsoft Sentinel to achieve unified M365 Defender security operations with complete endpoint visibility.
- Implemented CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across UAL's entire endpoint estate, delivering complementary endpoint behavioural detection and automated threat response alongside the Microsoft Defender suite.
- Developed SOAR automation playbooks using Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps and PowerShell, automating alert enrichment, IOC lookups and containment workflows to reduce analyst manual effort and improve Mean Time to Respond (MTTR).
- Deployed BeyondTrust PAM across the enterprise, enforcing least-privilege access principles and providing a full audit trail of privileged sessions to support ISO 27001 access control requirements.
- Led UAL's Cyber Essentials Plus certification, coordinating multi-team evidence collection across network, endpoint, identity, and cloud security control areas and achieving certification with no outstanding high-severity findings.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP75,000-85,000 | Hybrid (London/Manchester/UK)